



"Zip, zap, zoom!" Meet the ground squirrel, a feisty little creature that loves to dart around in the grasslands and forests. These cute critters are covered in fur that comes in shades of brown, grey, and sometimes black, which helps them blend into their surroundings. They are usually about 9 to 11 inches long, which is about the size of a big ruler, and they have bushy tails that add another 5 to 9 inches to their length. Ground squirrels have strong legs that are just perfect for digging burrows and running fast when they need to.

Speaking of burrows, let's talk about where these fun-loving animals live. Ground squirrels make their homes in burrows, which are like tunnels under the ground. These burrows are not only their homes, but also their hiding places from predators like foxes and hawks. You'll find these burrows in a variety of places, like grasslands, forests, and even in your own backyard if you live near their wild habitats!

Just like us, ground squirrels need food to stay healthy and active. They are omnivores, which means they eat both plants and small animals. Their diet includes nuts, seeds, fruits, vegetables, and sometimes insects and small birds. But did you know they hibernate in winter? They store food in their burrows to eat when they wake up in the spring.



Ground squirrels have a pretty cool life cycle and relationship with humans and other animals. Did you know that they hibernate in winter and wake up in spring? When they wake up, it's time to find a mate and have babies! While they might be a little naughty by digging holes in lawns, they also eat harmful insects, helping us in their own little way. And let's not forget, their alert calls warning of predators are a great help to other animals too. So, that's the story of the ground squirrel, a small animal with a big personality!



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) Why are ground squirrels sometimes considered helpful to humans?
A. They are good pets
B. They keep larger animals away from homes
C. They eat harmful insects
D. They are great climbers
- 2) Where do ground squirrels make their homes?
A. Under rocks B. Underground C. On tree branches D. In trees
- 3) What do ground squirrels use their strong legs for?
A. Climbing trees
B. Swimming in rivers
C. Hanging upside down
D. Digging burrows
- 4) What do ground squirrels eat?
A. Only plants
B. Only small animals
C. Both plants and small animals
D. Only nuts and seeds
- 5) When do ground squirrels wake up from hibernation?
A. In the spring B. In the summer C. In the fall D. In the winter
- 6) What color does the fur of a ground squirrel come in?
A. Red, Yellow, and Blue
B. Green, Orange, and Purple
C. White, Black, and Grey
D. Brown, Grey, and Black
- 7) Who are the predators of ground squirrels?
A. Foxes and Hawks
B. Tigers and Vultures
C. Wolves and Owls
D. Lions and Eagles
- 8) What do ground squirrels do during the winter?
A. They do not change their habits
B. They build nests in dense shrubs
C. They hibernate
D. They migrate to warmer places

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 9) "I travel south during the winter."
- 10) "I can be as long as a ruler!"
- 11) "Insects and small birds? Ew, no! I strictly eat grass."
- 12) "I like to build my home on the branches of trees."
- 13) "My home is a tunnel under the ground! I use it to sleep and hide from other animals."
- 14) "My tail is short, probably as short as your little finger."
- 15) "Unlike you, I hibernate in winter. I sleep for a long time and wake up in spring."
- 16) "I help spread seeds when I bury my food. Nature's little gardener, that's me!"
- 17) "My fur changes color to green in the summer, to blend with the grass."
- 18) "Before hibernating, I don't gather any food. I find fresh food in the middle of winter."
- 19) "My menu is quite diverse because I eat plants and small animals."

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 20) Ground squirrels usually have brown, grey or black coloured fur.



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- 48) Ground squirrels eat seeds, nuts, and fruits.
- 49) Why do ground squirrels dig burrows?
- 50) How fast can ground squirrels run?



Ground Squirrel

Name: _____

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3. _____ 28. _____
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25. _____ 50. _____



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|-----|----------------|-----|----------------------|
| 1. | C | 26. | fact |
| 2. | B | 27. | fact |
| 3. | D | 28. | opinion |
| 4. | C | 29. | opinion |
| 5. | A | 30. | true |
| 6. | D | 31. | false |
| 7. | A | 32. | true |
| 8. | C | 33. | false |
| 9. | Not | 34. | true |
| 10. | Would | 35. | false |
| 11. | Not | 36. | false |
| 12. | Not | 37. | false |
| 13. | Would | 38. | true |
| 14. | Not | 39. | true |
| 15. | Would | 40. | B |
| 16. | Would | 41. | A |
| 17. | Not | 42. | D |
| 18. | Not | 43. | A |
| 19. | Would | 44. | C |
| 20. | fact | 45. | declarative |
| 21. | opinion | 46. | interrogative |
| 22. | fact | 47. | declarative |
| 23. | opinion | 48. | declarative |
| 24. | fact | 49. | interrogative |
| 25. | opinion | 50. | interrogative |